

# **Operations PACE Food Safety Guide January 2026**



This guidance document is intended to focus on the key areas a Field Operations Consultant, unless otherwise indicated, should visually observe and discuss during the visit. It is not comprehensive and not intended to be a substitute for the items specifically identified in the McDonald's Food Safety Verification forms and does not modify the verification forms and procedures outlined in McDonald's Operations and Training Manual or any other similar documents.

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## **McDonald's Comprehensive Food Safety Program:**

**Running Great Restaurants Visit Food Safety:** During the Running Great Restaurants Visit (RGRV), the objective of the Food Safety Verification is to verify that the restaurant and the manager can demonstrate proper food safety procedures and practices. As a reminder, during an RGRV, FS5-US and FS6-US must be evaluated if breakfast products are served at any point while the visit is being conducted. This may require adjusting the timing of the observations.

**3rd Party Food Safety:** A food safety assessment is conducted to identify and mitigate food safety risks. EcoSure's 3<sup>rd</sup> party food safety program enables brand protection through an unbiased 3<sup>rd</sup> party assessment of McDonald's food safety standards. As such, EcoSure advisors may utilize the following resources and equipment as necessary to properly complete a McDonald's food safety audit.

- Copy of the McDonald's Food Safety Guide.
- Disposable Gloves.
- Pyrometer (Including back-up pyrometer and probe).
- Sanitizer Test Strips (Quat and chlorine).
- Hair Restraint.
- Flashlight.
- Access to all managed areas of the restaurant, including closets, utility rooms, sheds, etc.

**It is required that the restaurant immediately discontinue operations and notify the local health department if any imminent health hazard is found to exist** during the Food Safety Verification because of an emergency such as a fire, flood, extended interruption of electrical or water service, sewage backup, employee or customer exposure to toxic chemicals, a pest infestation (FS1-US), the onset of an apparent foodborne illness outbreak, significant employee illness outbreak, gross unsanitary occurrence or condition, or other circumstance that may endanger public health.

Note: Consult with your Field Operations Lead (FOL) or Operations Officer if the FOL cannot be reached to determine the next steps, up to and including restaurant closure.

**If any item is found to be out of compliance, the person completing the verification must verify and document that the item was corrected and/or addressed before leaving the restaurant.** To document the correction, use the comment box for each missing item and document the actions taken before leaving the restaurant. For items FS2-US - FS6-US, this must include a recheck of the internal temperatures of the cooked product to verify the required internal temperature is being met. Under no circumstances should a restaurant be permitted to serve undercooked beef, pork, chicken, fish, eggs, breakfast meats, or continue with a procedure that poses a food safety threat to our guests. Refer to the McDonald's Operations and Training Manual (O&T Manual) for all the procedures on taking corrective action when any product does not meet the required minimum internal temperature, including discarding the product, making adjustments, and cooking another run of the product to ensure that the issue is corrected.

For FS23-US and FS24-US, recheck product temperature to verify products are being held at the proper temperature. Refrigerated food products that have been in the temperature danger zone for longer than 4 hours (or frozen foods that are not solidly frozen) need to be discarded (see guidelines in the inventory chapter of the O&T Manual on refrigerator/freezer breakdown).

If heated leftover food products or products that are out of code or are not labeled with a secondary code date are found, they must be discarded.

If the verification reveals problems that cannot be corrected immediately, those problems should be reported to the Operations Manager (McOpCo) or the Franchise Business Partner without delay, and a decision must be made as to whether the restaurant should be closed until the problem can be corrected. Examples of this might include an equipment issue that requires a service technician to repair, a lack of proper supplies (e.g., disposable gloves, sanitizer, or Ecolab hand soap), or equipment (e.g., a working pyrometer or yolk breaking tool).

If an opportunity is found in an area that is not managed by McDonald's (e.g., Walmart, shared space with a gas station), then it shall not be cited on this assessment. Notify the responsible party if there is an opportunity in that area so it can be addressed.

**Remediation of 3rd Party Food Safety and associated follow-up visits that do not meet standards:**

- If any critical question, **FS-A-US** – FS7-US, is missed, an unannounced full Follow-up Food Safety Verification must occur within 14 days.
- If the visit does not meet standards due to a score below 80% and no critical questions are missed, an unannounced full Follow-up Food Safety Verification must be conducted between 30 - 90 days.

**Remediation of RGRV Food Safety and associated follow-up visits that do not meet standards:**

- If any critical question, **FS-A-US** – FS7-US, is missed, an unannounced Follow-up Food Safety Verification, consisting of a review of the missed item(s) only, must occur within 14 days.
- If the visit does not meet standards due to a score below 80% and no critical questions are missed, a scheduled and announced full Follow-up Food Safety Verification must be conducted between 30 - 90 days only if:
  - The overall score of the Running Great Restaurant Visit is less than 80% OR
  - Another component (Quality, Service, Cleanliness, Shift Leadership, and/or Health & Safety) also scores less than 80%.

When conducting a Follow-up Food Safety Verification, it is recommended that the visit not be conducted earlier than 9:30 a.m. so that regular menu product checks can be evaluated. The targeted length of this visit should be approximately 2 hours. Do not penalize the restaurant during this follow-up visit if not enough time has passed to correct an issue or exception. For follow-up visits to remedy any critical questions missed, the maximum number of days you can review is 14. (e.g., 60 days of completed food safety checklists, Health Department, and Pest Control violations).

The Field Operations Consultant (unless otherwise noted) conducting the visit should assess these areas through:

- Open and honest communication with the Owner/Operator (or their highest-ranking manager) or McOpCo Restaurant Managers and employees.
- Observations while on the visits, including reviewing documents that are checked in the verification.
- Reviewing past Food Safety Visit results.

The following verification principles should be followed as questions are assessed (not all-inclusive):

- Do not make comments in one question about observations you made under another question.
- Items identified as out of compliance during the visit will be scored as out of compliance even if corrected during the visit.

If the requirements denoted in this document conflict with other published requirements (e.g., national/state/local regulatory, building code, etc.), the most stringent requirement shall apply and be followed. Owner/Operators are solely responsible for understanding and complying with McDonald's standards and local regulations, where applicable, whichever is the most stringent.

**FS-A-US Immediate access to the area located behind the counter was granted to the assessor.**

**ASSESSMENT**

- Enter the restaurant and request to speak to the shift running manager.
- Inform the manager that the restaurant will be receiving a food safety audit.
- If the assessor is granted immediate access to the area behind the counter, begin the audit.
- If the assessor is not granted immediate access to the area behind the counter, discontinue the audit and leave the restaurant.

**CITE**

- If the restaurant does not grant the assessor immediate access (refuses entry) to begin the food safety audit.

**FS-B-US Restaurant is operating in a manner that does not pose any imminent health hazards to our guests and/or employees.**

**ASSESSMENT**

- Confirm the restaurant is not operating in conditions or with situations that could be considered imminent health hazards by the local health department (and could lead to an Order for Closure).
- Examples include, but are not limited to:
  - If there is no safe potable water (i.e., using tap water during a boil water order or advisory where operation has not been approved by the local Health Department and McDonald's corporation).
  - The restaurant is experiencing a sewage back-up.
  - The restaurant is experiencing flooding.
  - The loss of hot and cold running water.
  - Power outage.
  - Bathroom toilets or sinks are not operatable.
- If pest activity is observed, refer to standard FS1 and FS21.
- It is required that the restaurant immediately discontinue operations and notify the local health department if any imminent health hazard may exist because of an emergency such as a fire, flood, extended interruption of electrical or water service, sewage backup, employee or customer exposure to toxic chemicals, a pest infestation, the onset of an apparent foodborne illness outbreak, gross unsanitary occurrence or condition, or other circumstance that may endanger public health.

**CITE**

- If the restaurant is observed to be out of compliance and has not reacted appropriately to any situation which could be considered an imminent health hazard and/or lead to closure by the local health department.

**FS1-US Restaurant is free of infestation and/or signs of active pest (animal/ insect) infestation in the restaurant building, corral, shed, and any area within 10 feet (3m) of the building.**

**ASSESSMENT**

**Pests**

- Walk around the interior of the restaurant, including storage areas, and look under shelves and equipment for the presence of rodents, cockroaches, small flies, chewed boxes/food/wires, and/or droppings.
- Walk around the exterior within 10 feet of the restaurant and the corral area to ensure no pest infestation or signs of infestation are present. Corral areas are defined as the exterior area of the property, which may or may not be attached to the restaurant, and that is dedicated to the disposal of the restaurant's trash.
- The corral area is not evaluated in restaurants located within a Walmart or other locations where the corral area is not under the control of the restaurant.
- All sheds within the lot of free-standing restaurants should be considered as part of the corral. Before assessing the outside, ask the manager for their assistance to unlock the shed or other external storage areas. All sheds within the lot of free-standing restaurants should be assessed for pest infestation.

**CITE**

- If un-trapped live rodent(s) is observed.
- If any live cockroach(es) is observed.
- If any unmanaged or excessive presence of other pests.
- If greater than 5 small flies are congregating in one area, such as drains or areas with stagnant water. This could indicate a small fly infestation. Other examples of "one area" are service area, production area, storage area, or ware washing area.
- If any sign of an active pest infestation (e.g., fresh rodent droppings, cockroach eggs, damage from chewing, nesting material, etc.) is observed.
- If signs of pest infestation are present in the exterior shed/storage areas.

**CITE under FS21**

- One or more dead cockroaches.
- One or more trapped rodents.
- Any trailing ant activity in one area.
- If greater than 5 large flies are congregating in one area, such as the dining area, food prep area, front counter area, or food storage areas.

Contact your FOL or Ops Officer if you are unsure whether or not the restaurant has an infestation. If the restaurant has an infestation, determine the appropriate actions that can be taken with the Owner/Operator, up to and including closing the restaurant.

## **Conducting Internal Temperature Checks**

All product temperature checks must be conducted by the shift running manager on a full run of product using the restaurant's pyrometer.

- If more than one manager is working at the restaurant, ask them to decide who will demonstrate the process of taking product temperatures.
- Refer to the O&T Manual for the definition and procedures for the full run size. Refer to PQRG for full run maximums. A restaurant's full run size applies to all Food Safety Verifications. A restaurant's full run for the day may be less than the allowed maximum full run size.
  - o When conducting a Food Safety Audit (3rd Party Food Safety and associated follow-up visit), check one full run of each product being served. For chicken products (FS3), check McCrispy only.
  - o When conducting an RGRV Food Safety and associated follow-up visit:
    - Check each grill product cooked on each section of the grill for all grill platens in operation.
    - Check each fried product in a different fryer vat so that different vats are checked.

## **If you observe a product that does not meet the required food safety internal temperature standard**

Ask the manager to discard the product to ensure that the product is not served.

- Ask the manager to make the necessary adjustments per the O&T Manual troubleshooting section and cook another run of patties to demonstrate that the internal temperatures meet the food safety standard and that the issue is corrected.
- Note why the product did not meet temperature and record reason(s) in the PEAK visit form.
- For an RGRV, you should observe during the transition to the regular menu that the restaurant is completing the required food safety checks across all the platens where the product is cooked for the day, and that the products meet the internal temperature standard. If they are not completing the required checks or are not taking the proper corrective action if the product temperatures do not meet the standard, refer to **FS7**.

## **Transition from Breakfast Menu to Regular Menu**

- If you are conducting your internal temperature check during the one-hour transition period from breakfast to regular menu, review the DFS app before assessing product temperatures to determine if the daily food safety checks have been completed for regular menu products.

## **If the daily food safety check for a product has been completed**

- During the transition period, if any regular menu product does not meet the minimum internal temperature during assessment, and the daily food safety checks have been completed for that product, the finding should be cited.

## **If the daily food safety check for a product has not been completed**

- During the transition period, if any regular menu product does not meet the minimum internal temperature when assessing a product, and the daily food safety checks have not been completed for that product, the finding should not be cited.
- Ask the manager to complete the rest of their daily Food Safety Checklist as soon as possible to ensure that safe cooking temperatures are achieved for all products.

**ASSESSMENT**

**10:1 and 4:1 Beef Patties**

- Ask the manager or crew member to let you know when the next full run of 10:1 and 4:1 beef patties will be cooked.
- If not notified, you must ask them to cook the restaurant's full run size.
- If conducting a morning visit, you must wait to request this until they begin their lunch transition.
- **Ask the manager to** take the internal temperatures of the beef patties following the procedures in the O&T Manual.
- **Ask the manager, "What is the minimum internal temperature required for beef patties?"**
- The use of the black Hutzler spatula when taking temperatures of beef patties is recommended but not required.
- If the product does not meet the minimum required internal temperature, ask the manager to make the necessary adjustments per the O&T Manual and cook another run of patties to demonstrate that the internal temperatures meet the food safety standard and that the issue is corrected.

**CITE**

- If any internal temperatures of frozen or fresh beef after cooking are below 155°F.
- If the manager does not know the correct minimum internal cooking temperature for 4:1 fresh beef is 175°F, refer to **FS7**.
- If the manager fails to sanitize the pyrometer probe if the temperature of the product is below 155°F, refer to **FS27**.

**COACH**

- If any internal temperatures of 4:1 fresh beef after cooking are below 175°F but above 155°F.
- **If the manager does not know the correct minimum internal temperature for the 10:1 beef patties is 155°F.**

**FS3-US The internal temperatures of raw plant based and chicken products after cooking are at or above 165°F (74°C).**

**ASSESSMENT**

**Chicken and Plant Based Products**

- Ask the manager or crew member to let you know when the next full run of each chicken product is cooked.
  - When conducting a Food Safety Audit (3rd Party Food Safety and associated follow-up visit), check McCrispy only. If McCrispy Chicken patties are not available, verify the temperature of McCrispy Strips, McChicken patties, or Chicken McNuggets instead.
- If conducting a morning visit, you must wait to request this until they begin their transition to the regular menu.
- If not notified, you must ask them to cook the restaurant's full run size.
- **Ask the manager to** take the internal temperatures of the portions following the procedures in the O&T Manual.
- **Ask the manager, "What is the minimum internal temperature required for chicken?"**
- If any portion is below 165°F, move that portion off to the corner of the tray and let it sit for one additional minute, and then check it again. During the additional minute, ensure the run with the undercooked product is not placed in the UHC or served.
- If the product does not meet the minimum required internal temperature, ask the manager to take the appropriate corrective actions per the O&T Manual and cook another run of patties to demonstrate that the internal temperatures meet the food safety standard and that the issue is corrected.

**CITE**

- If any portion temperature (including portions that were allowed to sit for one additional minute before the temperature was checked again) is below 165°F.
- If the manager fails to sanitize the pyrometer probe if the temperature of the product is below 165°F, refer to **FS27**.

**COACH**

- **If the manager does not know the correct minimum internal temperature for the product.**



**FS4-US The internal temperature of Filet-O-Fish portions after cooking is at or above 155°F (69°C).**

**ASSESSMENT**

**Filet-O-Fish**

- Ask the manager or crew member to let you know when the next full run of Filet-O-Fish patties is cooked.
- If not notified, you must ask them to cook the restaurant's full run size.
- If conducting a morning visit, you must wait to request this until they begin their transition to the regular menu.
- Ask the manager to take the internal temperatures of the portions following the procedures in the O&T Manual.
- Ask the manager, "What is the minimum internal temperature required for Filet-O-Fish?"
- If any portion is below 155°F, move that portion off to the corner of the tray and let it sit for one additional minute, then check the portion again. During the additional minute, ensure the run with the undercooked product is not placed in the UHC or served.
- If the product does not meet the minimum required internal temperature, ask the manager to make the necessary adjustments per the O&T Manual and cook another run of filets to demonstrate that the internal temperatures meet the food safety standard and that the issue is corrected.

**CITE**

- If any portion temperature (including portions that were allowed to sit for one additional minute before the temperature was checked again) is below 155°F.
- If the manager fails to sanitize the pyrometer probe if the temperature of a product is below 155°F, refer to **FS27**.

**COACH**

- If the manager does not know the correct minimum internal temperature for the product.

**FS5-US The internal temperatures of breakfast sausage made from raw pork and breakfast steak are at or above 155°F (69°C).**

**ASSESSMENT**

**Breakfast Sausage and Breakfast Steak**

- Ask the manager or crew member to let you know when a full run of breakfast sausage and breakfast steak is cooked next.
- If not notified, you must ask them to cook the restaurant's full run size.
- **Ask the manager** to take the internal temperatures of the corner patties following the procedures in the O&T Manual.
- The internal temperatures of both breakfast steak and sausage must be checked if both products are being served at the time of the visit.
- **Ask the manager, "What is the minimum internal temperature required for both breakfast steak and sausage?"**
- If the product does not meet the minimum required internal temperature, ask the manager to make the necessary adjustments per the O&T Manual and cook another run of patties to demonstrate that the internal temperatures meet the food safety standard and that the issue is corrected.

**CITE**

- If any temperatures are below 155°F for steak or sausage.
- If the manager fails to sanitize the pyrometer probe if the temperature of the product is below 155°F, refer to **FS27**.

**COACH**

- **If the manager does not know the correct minimum internal temperature for the product.**

**ASSESSMENT**

**Round Eggs**

- Ask the manager or crew member to let you know when a full run of round eggs is cooked next.
- If not notified, you must ask them to cook the restaurant's full run size.
- Ask the manager to take the internal temperatures of the corner round eggs following the procedures in the O&T Manual.
- Ask the manager, "What is the minimum internal temperature required for round eggs?"
- The check for round eggs after cooking must always be completed if round eggs are being served during the visit.
- If the product does not meet the minimum required internal temperature, ask the manager to make the necessary adjustments per the O&T Manual and cook another run of eggs to demonstrate that the internal temperatures meet the food safety standard and that the issue is corrected.

**CITE**

- If any temperature is below 155°F.
- If the manager fails to sanitize the pyrometer probe if the temperature of the product is below 155°F, refer to **FS27**.

**COACH**

- If any egg yolks are not gelled (are runny).
- If the manager does not know the correct minimum internal temperature for the product.

**FS7-US The on-duty manager (or staff assigned to complete the checklist) can demonstrate they have been trained on properly completing the Daily Food Safety Checklist, including the ability to take corrective action.**

## **ASSESSMENT**

### **4:1 Beef Patty Demonstration of Knowledge**

- Check that the pyrometer probe was properly placed in the center of the beef patty and that all the patties that are cooked are being temped.
- Check that the manager can demonstrate the procedure of using the pyrometer and recording the temperatures using the DFS app.
  - If the DFS app is inoperable, ask the manager to demonstrate the procedure using a paper daily food safety checklist.
- State to the manager, “For McDonald’s, the minimum required temperature for 4:1 fresh beef patties is not the same as the minimum required temperature of the 10:1 patties.”
- Ask the manager, “What is the minimum internal temperature required for 4:1 fresh beef patties?”
- If the product does not meet the minimum required temperature, check that the manager takes the appropriate corrective actions.
- If the product does meet the minimum required temperature, ask the manager to state the appropriate corrective actions to take if the product does not meet the minimum required temperature.
- Below are the appropriate corrective actions to take for product that does not meet the minimum required temperature:
  - Discard the product.
  - Wash, rinse, and sanitize the probe, utensils, and tray after discarding product that did not meet minimum temperatures.
  - Take the appropriate action as outlined in McDonald’s protocol in the O&T Manual.
  - Run another product verification to ensure the correct cooking temperature is achieved.

## **CITE**

- If 2 or more of the 4 following are observed:
  - If the pyrometer is not properly placed in the center of the patties.
  - If the cooked product is not checked according to the McDonald’s O&T manual.
  - If the manager does not know the correct minimum required internal temperature after cooking. The correct internal temperature for 4:1 fresh beef is 175°F.
  - If one or more of the corrective action responses are incorrect.
    - Even if multiple corrective action steps are incorrect, observation number 4 should be assessed as non-compliant only one time, as the action steps are part of the same observation.

## **COACH**

- Coach for all other observations.

**FS8-US All Time-Temperature Control for Safety (TCS) refrigerated products in code (within primary shelf life).**

**ASSESSMENT**

**TCS Refrigerated Products**

- Check to make sure that the items stored in refrigerators are not expired per the manufacturer's expiration date (primary shelf life). **Randomly select 3 items to check.**
- Check time and temperature control for safety (TCS) foods like produce, fresh beef, Canadian bacon, dairy products such as shake and sundae mix, and apple slices and milk jugs in service area refrigerators.

**CITE**

- If the manufacturer's expiration date has expired for any of the refrigerated items assessed.

**COACH**

- If the primary shelf life of sauces, dressings, and other non-TCS food products are expired.

**FS9-US Handwashing sinks: There is running warm water and required supplies at all handwashing sinks. Handwashing sinks are easily accessed by employees and only used for hand washing, not preparing food or storing equipment.**

**ASSESSMENT**

**Hand Sinks Stocked**

- Check all hand sinks, including restrooms, for stocked and functional soap dispensers and paper towels or a functional hand dryer (restroom only).
- All hand sinks must be functional and provide water at a minimum of 100°F. Allow 1-2 minutes for the water temperature to reach and maintain the temperature and check the temperature using a calibrated pyrometer.

**Accessibility**

- Sinks should not be obstructed and should be easily accessed by employees.
- Employees should be able to wash their hands easily without any challenges, such as not being able to reach taps or paper towels.
- No other tasks involving food prep, food contact surfaces, or wiping cloths may be completed at the handwashing sink (e.g., utensils rinsed or left in the sink, lemons washed in the sink, towels left or rinsed, dumping beverages or ice, etc.).

**CITE**

- If restrooms do not have at least one stocked, functional soap dispenser and either paper towels or at least one functional dryer.
- If no warm running water of at least 100°F.
- If any hand sink is used for any purposes other than handwashing.
- If any hand sink is not accessible.
- If non-Ecolab hand soap is stocked at a hand sink, only CITE under **FS28**.

**COACH**

- If paper towels are **visible and located within reach of the** hand sink but not stocked in the dispenser.

## **ASSESSMENT**

### **Washing Hands when Required**

Check that employees are washing their hands at the appropriate times.

- Before putting on new clear/white disposable gloves when changing tasks.
- After performing a non-food task (mopping, taking out the trash, and retrieving food from the walk-in refrigerator or stockroom).
- After taking a break or using the restroom.
- Before entering the production area and going to work at the food preparation stations.
- After coughing/sneezing or touching any part of the body.
- After handling their cell phone and resuming with food prep.
- Note: Employees are not required to wash their hands after removing a pair of blue gloves and then putting on a new pair of blue gloves while working in the same station.

## **CITE**

- If one or more employees are observed not following the proper handwashing procedure.

### **Handwashing System**

Ask the manager, “What time is your next handwashing cycle? How are you tracking that?”

- The manager should describe a process that identifies a method for tracking time to ensure this occurs on an hourly basis for all employees. For example, this could be that they link it to another hourly routine, like a travel path, or it could be a timer.
- If the manager can tell you when the next hand wash is (should be within the next hour) and they can explain a reliable process to track the time, this is acceptable.
- If the hourly hand wash is observed, check to see that the manager monitors all employees for handwashing.

## **CITE**

- If it is evident that there is no **repeatable** process in place. Example: if the manager states that a timer is used to monitor handwashing, but the timer is broken or not in use.
- If the hourly hand washing process is observed and the manager does not ensure that all employees wash their hands.

**FS11-US Sanitized towel/cloth buckets: Sanitized towel buckets contain towels and chlorine sanitizer solution at the correct concentration checked with a chlorine test strip.**

**ASSESSMENT**

**Chlorine Test Strips**

- Ask the manager or a crew member for chlorine test strips/kits used to check sanitizer buckets.
- The chlorine test strips must be in usable condition (not water-damaged) and not expired.
- If found water-damaged or expired, ensure that they are the only test strips available before citing.
- The Quat test strips will be assessed under question **FS13**.

**Clean Towel Bucket Sanitizer Concentration**

- To test the chlorine concentration in the towel bucket, use the restaurant's test strips and follow the procedures in the O&T Manual.

**CITE**

- If the concentration is less than 50 ppm (only coach, do not cite if higher than 100 ppm).
- If chlorine test strips are damaged/expired.
- If chlorine test strips are not readily available.

**Sanitizer Bucket Use**

- Sanitized and soiled towel buckets should be located at the grill and near the front counter.
- If the unit is small (ex., a Walmart restaurant) and one bucket can be easily accessed from all areas, this is acceptable.

**CITE**

- If there are no clean towels in the clean towel buckets.
- If no clean towel buckets are set up.

**COACH**

- If the bucket has a missing or expired 2-hour time label.

**FS12-US Sanitizer-soaked towels/cloths: Sanitizer-soaked towels and grill clothes used at food, beverage preparation, and service areas are placed into the soiled towel bucket after use and not left sitting out on surfaces.**

**ASSESSMENT**

- Sanitizer-soaked towels and grill cloths must be placed in the soiled towel bucket after every use.
- They should not be left sitting out on surfaces or placed back into the clean towel sanitizer bucket.
- If a towel is placed momentarily on a surface but is observed to be in continuous use (e.g., when sanitizing a pyrometer probe between product temperature checks), do not cite.

**CITE**

- If sanitized towels are not in active/continuous use and are left sitting out on surfaces.
- If soiled towels are observed with clean towels in the clean towel bucket.

**FS13-US Utensils and trays sanitizing: All in-use UHC trays, grill utensils, prep table utensils, and utensil holders are clean (no build-up), washed, rinsed, and sanitized at least every 4 hours as per approved procedure. The back sink and soap/sanitizer dispensers or warewashers function (hot water 110°F or higher in the wash bin/sink) with all required supplies. The sanitizer solution has the right concentration when checked with an appropriate test strip.**

## **ASSESSMENT**

### **UHC Trays/Small Wares**

- Randomly select a combination of 5 items (total) from the in-rotation utensils (spatulas, yellow yolk breaking tool, etc.), utensil holders, plastic, and wire UHC trays being stored on the back-of-house dry storage shelves for future use.
- Check that all in-rotation utensils are free from grease and product build-up.

## **CITE**

- If grease and/or product build-up is observed on 3 or more of the 5 selected. Describe the build-up observed.

### **4-Hour System for In-Use Food Contact Surfaces**

- To assess for a system in place, ask the manager, “When is the next time that your in-use trays and utensils will be washed/rinsed/sanitized? Please explain the process used.”

## **CITE**

- If the manager cannot describe a process, including how the 4-hour time requirement is being tracked and how they ensure that all in-use utensils are being addressed. For example, it is done at the transition between breakfast and lunch; have set periods where they can readily communicate and remove in-use utensils by stations; have a backup set to swap out.

### **3-Compartment Sink and Quat Sanitizer Concentration/Test Strips**

If the 3-compartment sink is observed in active use, assess that it is set up properly and that the proper wash, rinse, and sanitize procedures are being followed.

- Allow 1-2 minutes for the water temperature to reach and maintain temperature and check the temperature using a calibrated pyrometer. Ensure that the 3-compartment sink **dispenses** hot water at a minimum of 110°F in the wash bin/sink and is stocked with detergent and sanitizer. Both chemical dispensers should be functional.
- Check the Quat sanitizer concentration from the automated dispenser even when the 3-part sink is not in use. Ask the manager or a crew member for the Quat test strips used to check the 3-compartment sink. The Quat test strips must be in usable condition (not water-damaged) and not expired. If found water-damaged or expired, ensure that they are the only test strips available before citing.

## **CITE**

- If the back sink or chemical dispensers are not functional.
- If the temperature of water **dispensed by the wash bin/sink faucet** does not **disperse** at a minimum of 110°F.
- If the Quat concentration is below 200 ppm.
- If proper wash, rinse, and sanitize procedures are not being followed.
- If Quat test strips are damaged or expired.



**Warewasher**

- Test the chlorine sanitizer in the warewasher if present.

**Low Temperature Machine**

- Run the warewasher for one cycle.
- Open the door and remove the rack.
- Dip the chlorine strip into the tank water solution and immediately blot on a paper towel.
- Choose the color on the chart that most closely matches the color of the test strip.

**CITE**

- If the concentration is below 50 ppm.
- If the proper wash, rinse, and sanitize procedures are not being followed.

**COACH**

- If the concentration is higher than 100 ppm.

**High Temperature**

- Place the adhesive label onto a ware.
- Run the ware through the warewash machine.
- After the cycle is complete, check the label. It turns from white to black when it reaches the proper temperature of 160°F.

**CITE**

- If the adhesive label does not read 160°F or higher.
- If the proper wash, rinse, and sanitize procedures are not being followed.

**COACH**

- If any soiled raw wares that may have come into contact with fresh beef are not washed and sanitized last (or in a separate load in the warewasher).
- If soiled blue raw beef trays and lids are not kept in the blue bus box until cleaned.
- If the back sink is not properly sanitized after washing soiled raw wares.

**FS14-US State of cleanliness: The restaurant (all areas) is in a good state of cleanliness. In all areas, the floors/walls/ceiling and equipment do not have dust/dirt/food build-up. There should not be a pool of standing water in the restaurant.**

## **ASSESSMENT**

### **Structure**

- Check that the floors, walls, and ceilings are maintained clean with no excessive build-up of grease or food debris (more than 1-day build-up). Describe any build-up observed.
- Check that there is no standing water in the restaurant. If standing water is observed, determine the source of the water (equipment, spill, etc.).
- Ask the manager, “When is the next time that restrooms are scheduled to be cleaned? What is your system for ensuring that restrooms are cleaned at least every 2 hours?” to determine if there is a 2-hour restroom cleaning process in place.

### **CITE**

- If floors, walls, or ceilings have an excessive build-up of grease or food debris (more than 1-day build-up).
- If very low or no grout is observed in 2 or more of the following 4 areas: kitchen, front counter, back sink, and storage.
- If floors and floor drains with food debris, excessive grease/food debris build-up under the grill/fryer, mold build-up along the wall at the 3-compartment sink, etc., are observed.
- If standing water is observed and is a result of improperly functioning equipment, such as a leaking ice machine, improperly functioning drain, etc.
- If there is no process in place to ensure that restrooms are cleaned at least every two hours.

### **Equipment**

- Check all in-use equipment that is used to prepare or hold food for cleanliness.
- Equipment in storage should not be assessed.
- Cleanliness of UHC equipment (plastic/wire trays) and utensils should not be assessed under this question but rather under **FS13**.

### **CITE**

- If excessive, encrusted food debris, mold/organic matter, or grease build-up is observed.
- If mold or build-up on soda nozzles or mold/organic matter build-up on blended ice machine rinsing area for pitchers is observed.

### **COACH**

- If less than an excessive build-up of grease or food debris (less than a day of build-up) on non-food contact areas, such as spillage of fries in a secondary freezer, is observed.
- If dust build-up on non-food contact surfaces is observed.

**FS15-US State of repair: The building and equipment is functioning properly and in a good state of repair (not cracked or damaged). The freezers should not have an excess build-up of ice that would prohibit the unit to function properly.**

## **ASSESSMENT**

### **Structure**

- Check that the floors, walls, and ceilings are maintained in good repair.
- Check that there is no significant damage to floors, walls, and ceilings.

### **CITE**

- If floors, walls, or ceiling tiles (including light shields) are damaged and present a potential physical contamination hazard.
- If floors, walls, or ceiling tiles (including light shields) are missing in food preparation or storage areas.

### **COACH**

- If floors, walls, or ceiling tiles are missing or damaged in other areas of the restaurant.

### **Equipment**

- Check that all in-use equipment that is used to prepare or hold food is in good repair.

### **CITE**

- If food equipment is damaged and presents a potential physical contamination hazard.
  - e.g., frayed fry baskets with metal pieces sticking out, broken/frayed UHC wire racks, notably cracked food contact surfaces such as food pans, blended ice pitchers, etc.
- If food equipment is no longer smooth and easily cleanable, and could harbor food or bacteria.
  - e.g., an ice transfer bucket or a plastic spatula that is heavily scratched/gouged.
- If the grease trap is not working properly and is overflowing. Depending on the severity of this observation, it may be classified as a sewage backup, and the restaurant should follow the imminent health hazard information at the top of the guide for remediation activities.
- If the freezers have excessive condensation or ice build-up that would prohibit the unit from functioning properly. Excessive means layered and three-dimensional ice build-up, not a little frost.
  - e.g., ice build-up covering the condenser fans, condensate drip pan, or evaporator coils.

### **COACH**

- If the freezers have ice build-up on floors, walls, or ceiling.

**FS16-US Water and ice: Appropriate measures taken to protect water and ice from foreign material, chemicals, and/or microbial contamination. Water filters are in date, and ice machines are free from mold.**

**ASSESSMENT**

**Ice Machine**

- Check that the back of the house ice machine is maintained clean inside and free from visible mold or build-up.
  - Cell phone cameras should not be used to assess this question.
- Check for mold or build-up in the ice machine by wiping a **sanitized towel** across the metal drop plate and around the inner walls.
- Check that the ice machine door seals properly to protect the ice from any foreign contamination.
- Check that ice bins and ice chutes are clean. Through visual inspection, look for mold or build-up. **This can show up as grooves with dark coloring.**

**CITE**

- If the ice bucket is stored upright (not inverted) or stored on the floor.
- If there is visible mold or build-up in the ice machine, ice bins, or on ice chutes.
- If there is visible mold or build-up in the ice transfer bucket or ice scoops. **This can show up as grooves with dark coloring.**
- Ice scoop not stored in the holder.
- Ice bins are not kept covered.
- Anything other than a designated ice scoop used to handle ice (e.g., cup).

**Water Filters**

- Ask the Manager if the restaurant participates in the Coca-Cola QMP program (i.e., Coke technicians manage the replacement of the water filters).
  - If the manager states, “Yes”, there is no need to check that the water filters are dated.
  - If the manager states “No”, check that the water filters are dated.

**CITE**

- If the water filters are not dated. Do not assess the date itself.

**COACH**

- If the restaurant does not have a system in place that identifies and tracks when the water filters need to be replaced.

**FS17-US Food product opened: Opened packages of food in storage (including dry storage, refrigerators, and freezers) covered/wrapped, labeled, off the floor, and away from walls. Product stored according to proper procedures.**

**ASSESSMENT:**

**Labeled**

- Check that all food in dry storage, refrigerators, and freezers is stored in the original packaging or labeled and easily identified.
- Do not assess the product in the French fry dispenser.

**CITE**

- If the product is stored in dry storage, refrigerators, and freezers are not stored in original packaging or labeled and are not able to be easily identified.

**Prep Area Coolers**

- Check that all products are stored covered.
- Do not cite products left in open bags or stored uncovered in the grill side refrigerator and freezer or the fryer side freezer, as these are considered to be in continuous use.
- If plastic wrap is used, it must effectively protect the entire product.

**CITE**

- If the product is not stored covered. Do not cite products left in open bags or stored uncovered in the grill side refrigerator and freezer or the fryer side freezer, as these are considered to be in continuous use.
- If raw products are not stored separately from ready-to-eat foods (RTE foods) as outlined in the McDonald's procedures for storing products; for example, shell eggs not in the original case are stored on the same shelf or above produce or other RTE foods.
- If there is open product and glass/porcelain/crockery stored above it.

**Walk-in Refrigerator and Walk-in Freezers**

- Check that all products are covered and 2 inches away from the wall and 6 inches off the floor.
- If plastic wrap is used, it must effectively protect the entire product.

**CITE**

- If the product is touching the wall or if the product is touching the floor.
- If the product is not stored covered.

**Dry Storage/Stockroom**

- Check that all food products are stored covered and 6 inches off the floor.
- If plastic wrap is used, it must effectively protect the entire product.

**CITE**

- If the product is stored uncovered. Cite only for exposed food, not packaged food, inside an open case.
- If the product/product case is stored directly on the floor.

**COACH**

- If food is stored below 6 inches in any area, but is not directly on the floor.

**FS18-US Raw food product handling: Blue or colored disposable glove procedures (or other globally approved procedures) used to prevent cross-contamination when handling all raw meat or poultry products (including shell eggs) at the grill station. Dedicated utensils used for raw products (e.g., the yellow egg yolk breaking tool is only used to break egg yolks).**

## **ASSESSMENT**

### **Blue Glove Usage**

- Check that when employees handle raw protein products, they are wearing blue disposable gloves or are using dedicated tongs to handle raw protein products. Focus on raw meat, chicken, and shell eggs.
- Ensure that clear/white gloves are not being used instead of blue gloves to handle raw protein products. If observed, CITE under question FS19.
- It is acceptable if bare hands are used to handle non-raw protein products during the cooking process at the grill or fryer (ex., folded eggs, Canadian bacon, liquid eggs, hash browns). The use of clear or blue gloves is also acceptable when preparing this product.

### **CITE**

- If blue gloves are not removed before:
  - Touching trays, tray liners, utensils, or equipment to lower platens.
  - Removing cooked products from the grill.
  - Moving to the prep table.
  - When cooking chicken, blue gloves are not removed before the fryer basket handle is touched.
  - If bare-hand contact is used for handling raw product at the grill/fryer.
  - If dedicated tongs are used for anything other than handling raw protein products.

### **COACH**

- If bare-hand contact is observed with chicken McNuggets as they are being poured into the fry basket.

### **Proper Removal of Blue Gloves**

- Check that blue gloves are removed properly to avoid bare hand contact with the parts of the glove that touched raw products.
- Check that blue gloves are peeled off from the base of the glove while grabbing from the back of the wrist and pulling off the glove by turning it inside out.
- Check that they are not pulled off from fingers or an area that contact with raw products.

### **CITE**

- If blue gloves are not removed using the proper procedure.
- If blue glove removal is initiated from the front of the wrist instead of the back of the wrist.
- If double gloving is observed (unless in rare cases where it is required by local jurisdiction, e.g., Maricopa County, AZ).

### **Egg Yolk Breaking Tool**

- Check that the yellow egg yolk breaking tool is only used to break egg yolks.

### **CITE:**

- If the egg yolk breaking tool is not available or used properly.
- If the egg yolk breaking tool is not used to break raw egg yolks.
- If the egg yolk breaking tool is used for items other than raw eggs.
- If the egg yolk breaking tool is improperly stored in contact with food or utensils used for cooked food.

**ASSESSMENT:**

**Clear/White Disposable Glove Usage with Ready-to-Eat Foods**

- Check that employees are wearing clear/white disposable gloves when working with ready-to-eat food under the following circumstances:
  - Working at the prep table, preparing and wrapping sandwiches.
  - Working at the salad prep table, sorting lettuce, and slicing lemons.
  - Performing all other prep tasks with ready-to-eat foods.
  - Placing a new liner in tea and coffee dispensers.
- It is acceptable for bare hands to be used to handle non-raw protein products during the cooking process at the grill or fryer (ex., folded eggs, Canadian bacon, liquid eggs, hash browns). The use of clear or blue gloves is also acceptable when preparing this product.

**CITE**

- If disposable gloves are not worn as listed above, or if bare-hand contact is observed for handling ready-to-eat foods that will not be heated or cooked.
- If clear/white gloves are being used to handle raw protein products instead of blue gloves.

**COACH**

- If hands are washed before handling these products with bare hands or suggest that blue gloves or dedicated tongs are also acceptable.

**Clear/white disposable gloves are removed when required, and no double gloving of disposable gloves.**

- Check that employees are not wearing a double set of clear gloves.
- Check that gloves are not being reused and are replaced when damaged or contaminated before resuming food handling/preparation. (e.g., getting stock from walk-in coolers, handling trash, etc.).
- It is acceptable for employees who are performing tasks in the 3-compartment sink/storage areas to wear clear/white gloves as they wash dishes and handle garbage.
- It is acceptable for employees to wear clear/white gloves when performing cleaning tasks in the front or back of the house.
- It is acceptable for employees wearing clear/white gloves to touch the prep area refrigerator handles and resume food prep.
- If gloves are changed when required but hands are not washed, CITE under FS10.

**CITE**

- If you have witnessed the entire process of the clear/white disposable gloves getting contaminated and food handling/preparation being resumed.

**Fingernails**

- Check that all employees who prepare food have fingernails that are trimmed, filed, and maintained so the edges and surfaces are cleanable and not rough.
- Check that employees do not wear fingernail polish or artificial fingernails when working with exposed food, unless they are wearing intact disposable gloves that are not torn or damaged.

**CITE**

- If employees are observed handling exposed food with fingernail polish/artificial fingernails or fingernails that are not trimmed, filed, and maintained so the edges and surfaces are cleanable and not rough unless they are wearing intact disposable gloves that are not torn or damaged.

**Jewelry**

- Check that all employees who prepare food are not wearing jewelry on their arms or hands except for a plain ring, such as a wedding band.

**CITE**

- If employees are preparing food while wearing jewelry that is more than a plain ring on their arms or hands.

**Hair Restraints**

- Check that all employees who prepare food in the kitchen are wearing a hat, visor, or hairnet and beard covering to properly restrain hair from falling into food.

**CITE**

- If hair is not properly restrained and has the potential to fall into food.

**COACH**

- If employees do not remove hair restraints before using the restroom.

**Uniforms and Aprons**

- Check that there is no excessive encrusted food build-up on clothing/aprons worn by employees.
- Ask the manager what their system is for ensuring employees come to work with a clean uniform, and employees working in the production area are provided with clean aprons.

**CITE**

- If excessively encrusted food build-up that can flake off and fall into food (e.g., heavy food debris) is observed on the outer clothing/aprons of an employee handling open food.
- If an employee is observed wearing a uniform/apron that is not in good repair (e.g., holes, tears).
- If an employee does not remove their apron before using the restroom.

**Employee Food & Beverages**

- Check that all employee food and beverages are stored and consumed only in designated areas where the contamination of exposed food, clean equipment, utensils, linens, unwrapped single-service, and single-use articles or other items needing protection cannot result.

**CITE**

- If employees store or consume food (including gum) and beverages in undesignated areas, where the contamination of exposed food, clean equipment, utensils, linens, unwrapped single-service, and single-use articles or other items needing protection can result.



**FS20-US Chemical Management: All chemicals are clearly labeled and stored away from food and packaging.**

**ASSESSMENT**

**Chemical Storage**

- Check that chemicals are stored away from food or food contact surfaces/packaging in the back-of-house food prep/kitchen areas, service areas, and storage areas when not in active use. For example, the grill cleaner should not be left at the grill station when not in active use, and spray bottles should not be stored in the front-line area next to or above food or packaging.
- Check that chemicals are not being improperly used, posing a risk of contamination of food or food contact surfaces (ex., spraying around open food or packaging).
- Check that chemicals are not stored in food containers.
- Check that chemical containers have a label attached or are clearly labeled with the name of the chemical.
- The use of handwritten labels is acceptable for items where a manufacturer's label is not available.

**CITE**

- If chemicals that are not in active use are stored near food, food contact surfaces, or packaging in food prep, kitchen, service, and storage areas.
- Chemicals are not being properly used and pose a risk of contamination of food or food contact surfaces.
- Chemicals are stored in food containers.
- Chemical containers do not have a label attached or are not clearly labeled with the name of the chemical.

**FS21-US Pest management: Pest management program is in place and working effectively. Restaurant is pest proofed to prevent entry of pests (e.g., gaps under doors are sealed, Drive Thru window closed when not in use).**

## **ASSESSMENT**

### **Confirm that the restaurant has a Pest Management Program in place.**

- Ask the manager to show you a pest service report from their last visit. As long as a service report is available within the last 60 days, this will suffice as having a program in place. Check that there are no ongoing pest activity issues noted in the report. If pest activity was noted in the previous report, verify that the pest is not still present.
- Review the most recent pest control report, ensure that all recommendations have been corrected or are in an action plan to correct.

## **CITE**

- If the restaurant is not pest proofed, and all potential entry points do not have adequate seals.
- If the report is older than 60 days, or if no pest service report is available for review.
- If the pest management program and pest prevention steps and behaviors are not in place or are not complete.
- If there are any gaps underneath any entry doors.
- If doors do not have sweeps/weather stripping or are not kept closed when not in use.
- If either Drive Thru window is left open and there are no cars in the Drive Thru.

## **COACH**

- If either Drive Thru window is left open while not in active use (i.e., not closed between cars).

### **Pest Activity**

- Assess all areas of the restaurant for pest activity as you complete the food safety audit.

## **CITE**

- If one or more dead cockroaches are observed.
- If one or more trapped rodents are observed.
- If trailing ant activity in one area is observed.
- If high large fly activity is present, meaning greater than 5 are congregating in one area, such as the dining area, food prep area, front counter area, or food storage areas.

**FS22-US Non-food / biohazard spill procedures are in place.****ASSESSMENT****Non-Food Spill Procedures**

- Ask a manager to see the McDonald's approved procedures that explain proper clean-up of non-food spills.
- If the manager presents a documented procedure, check that it is the McDonald's approved procedure (Ecolab Kay card, McD SOP, or O&T).
- If the manager does not have the McDonald's approved documented procedure, ask them to describe the correct procedure and the correct disinfectant chemical to use (per current Ecolab Kay card).
- Ask the manager to show you that the correct disinfectant chemical is available in the restaurant.
- If the restaurant has a non-McDonald's kit that is required by their local health jurisdiction, ensure that they are knowledgeable about the McDonald's approved documented procedure and have the correct chemical to use on site.
- If a non-food spill occurs while completing the visit, observe that the proper procedures are followed.

**CITE**

- If the manager presents a procedure that is not the approved McDonald's procedure.
- If the manager describes a procedure that is not the approved McDonald's procedure.
- If the correct disinfectant chemical (per the current Ecolab Kay card) is not available in the restaurant.
- If a non-food spill occurs while completing the visit, and proper procedures are not followed.

**FS23-US Frozen products: Walk-in freezers and any other primary storage freezers keep products at 0°F (-18°F) or below. Secondary storage freezers keep products solidly frozen.****ASSESSMENT****Frozen Products**

- Check that the temperature display of the walk-in freezer indicates a temperature of 0°F or below.
- Randomly select one product in the walk-in freezer.
- Check that the temperature of the product stored in the walk-in freezer is 0°F or below.
  - Do not pierce products packaged in bags with a pyrometer probe. Check the temperature of the product packaged in bags by wrapping the bag around the pyrometer.
- Randomly select one product from a grill side freezer and one from a wall unit freezer.
- Check that the product in the grill side and the wall freezers is solidly frozen with no signs of thawing.

**CITE**

- If the temperature of the product assessed in the walk-in freezer is not 0°F or below.
- If the product assessed in the grill side and/or wall unit freezers is not solidly frozen.

**COACH**

- If the temperature of the product assessed in the walk-in freezer is 0°F or below, but the freezer display does not indicate a temperature of 0°F or below.

**FS24-US Refrigerated products: All products in the walk-in refrigerator and any other primary storage refrigerator at or below 40°F (4°C) (including shake/sundae in reservoir). All products in secondary storage refrigerators are kept at the correct temperature.**

## **ASSESSMENT**

### **Refrigerated Products**

#### **Non-RTS Equipped Restaurants**

- Check that the temperature display for beverage equipment, such as shake machines, coffee machine cold milk reservoir, and blended ice machines indicates a temperature of 40°F or below.
  - If the temperature display for any beverage equipment, such as shake machines, coffee machine cold milk reservoir, and blended ice machines indicates a temperature of 40°F or above, use the pyrometer to manually take the temperature of the product stored in that piece of equipment.
- Take internal temperatures of 2 different food products from the walk-in refrigerator in opposite locations of the unit.
- Take internal temperatures in 2 of the most frequently used secondary/reach-in refrigerators. This must include a product temperature from the refrigerated unit near the prep line or sandwich area holding multiple produce products.

#### **RTS Equipped Restaurants**

- Check that the temperature display for beverage equipment, such as shake machines, coffee machine cold milk reservoir, and blended ice machines indicates a temperature of 40 ° or below.
  - If the temperature display for any beverage equipment, such as shake machines, coffee machine cold milk reservoir, and blended ice machines indicates a temperature of 40°F or above, use the pyrometer to manually take the temperature of the product stored in that piece of equipment.
- Take internal temperatures of 2 different food products from the walk-in refrigerator in opposite locations of the unit.
- Review RTS data from the previous day along with any corrective actions for non-compliant temperatures that may have been recorded.
- If RTS records confirm that all secondary/ reach-in refrigerator temperatures from the previous day were maintained at or below 40°F:
  - Record the current RTS temperature readings for the 2 most frequently used secondary/reach-in refrigerators instead of using a pyrometer to take temperatures.
- If RTS records indicate that 1 or more secondary/ reach-in refrigerator temperatures from the previous day are not at or below 40°F:
  - Use a pyrometer to manually take the internal temperatures in 2 of the most frequently used secondary/reach-in refrigerators. This must include a product temperature from the refrigerated unit near the prep line or sandwich area holding multiple produce products.

## **CITE**

- If either of the two product temperatures in the walk-in refrigerator is above 40°F.
- If any product temperatures found in the secondary/reach-in refrigerators that were checked are above 40°F.

## **COACH**

- If any temperature for a product that is manually assessed with a pyrometer is at or below 40°F, but the display of the cooler unit or beverage equipment does not indicate a temperature of 40°F or below.

**FS25-US Shelf lives: All in-use products held in refrigerators or at room temperature are marked and being used within their secondary shelf lives.**

**ASSESSMENT**

**Labeling of Opened/Prepped TCS Products Held at Room Temperature**

- Check that the following TCS products held at room temperature are marked with a secondary shelf life, are not expired per the marked secondary shelf life, and that no marked shelf lives are greater than four hours from the current time.
  - Shredded lettuce, sliced tomatoes, all types of cheese, and all types of onions held at the prep table or in the chilled rail.
  - Meat (Canadian bacon) and egg products near the grill area that are stored at room temperature.
  - Apple slices, butter pats, or other TCS foods held at room temperature or in chill pans.
  - Softened butter held in a squeeze bottle or food pan at room temperature.
- Check that if an approved timing app is used as an alternative to marking the product with a secondary shelf, each container of product held at room temperature has a countdown timer allocated to each container of product.
- Check that the countdown timer has not expired, and the expiration time is not greater than 4 hours from the current time.
  - Some health departments may not allow the use of timing in an app as a replacement for marking the product with a secondary shelf life or expiration time.

**CITE**

- If TCS food items stored at the prep table, in the chilled rail, service, or grill area are not marked with a legible secondary shelf life or are not being timed if a timing app is being used.
- If TCS foods are expired per the secondary life marked on the product (or the time has expired if using a timing app).
- If the time marked on the product (or on the timing app) is greater than 4 hours from the current time.

**Labeling of Opened/Prepped TCS Products Held Under Refrigeration:**

- Check that a sampling of 5 opened, prepped, or thawing-from-frozen TCS products is properly labeled with a secondary shelf life and are not expired per the marked secondary shelf life.

**CITE**

- If the secondary shelf life of 3 or more TCS products (out of 5 products checked) is found to be expired or not marked with a secondary shelf life.

**COACH**

- If the secondary shelf life of 2 or fewer TCS products and freezer (out of 5 products checked) is found to be expired or not marked with a secondary shelf life.

**FS26-US Leftover heated foods: All leftover heated foods are discarded (including expired food in the UHC and any shake/sundae mix removed from heat treatment shake/sundae machines). Heated food products (proteins) are not held below 140 °F (60 °C) or beyond their defined time.**

## **ASSESSMENT**

### **Leftover Heated Foods**

- Check that no previously heated foods have been placed in the walk-in or reach-in refrigerators for use the next day (such as sauces and gravies).
- Food used for the “Food Donation” program must be stored in the freezer and never in a refrigerator. These products will typically be stored in a plastic bag in the freezer and should not be assessed for labeling/expiration.

### **CITE**

- If cooked/heated foods are being saved (unless being saved for a “Food Donation” program).
- Food used for the “Food Donation” program is not stored in the walk-in freezer.
- If the shake and sundae mix removed from the heat treatment shake/sundae machine is being saved in the walk-in refrigerator.

### **Heated Products-Hot Holding**

- Check that the temperatures of 3 randomly selected products in the UHC, Marinator, and/or Breakfast Staging Cabinet are at or above 140°F.
- Do not check/observe for Canadian bacon, muffins, biscuits, **hotcakes**, or bagel products holding at appropriate temperatures.

### **CITE**

- If any product being held hot is below 140°F.
- If no timing mechanism (such as UHC timers set) is in place.

**ASSESSMENT:**

**Pyrometer**

- Ask the shift manager to calibrate the restaurant's pyrometer by following the procedures listed in the McDonald's O&T Manual.
- Check that the pyrometer is calibrated within +/- 2°F of 32°F in accordance with McDonald's procedures.
- It is not necessary to adjust or compensate readings when taking product temperatures with a properly calibrated pyrometer.
- If the restaurant has already done its calibration check for its Bluetooth pyrometer for the day, it is acceptable to have the manager show you the verification in the digital food safety checklist. This only applies to the Bluetooth pyrometer.
- Check if the restaurant has a backup pyrometer, spare batteries, and a needle probe.
- Check that the probe is clean.

**CITE**

- If there is excessive, encrusted food residue present.
- If the probe is not sanitized before use with a ready-to-eat product.
- If the needle is not sanitized after an unacceptable temperature reading.
- If they do not have a backup pyrometer, batteries, and needle probe readily available.

**FS28-US Sourcing: All food, food packaging, equipment (including utensils), and cleaning chemicals are from approved sources.**

**ASSESSMENT**

**Sourcing**

- Check that all food, food packaging, equipment, and cleaning chemicals are from the McDonald's Distribution Center and have a WRIN number on the case.
- Check that cleaning chemicals come from the Distribution Center; primarily, these will be Ecolab/Kay products.
- Check that there is no store-bought food or food not provided by McDonald's Suppliers in storage areas or **being prepared for service to customers**. This does not include restaurant employee food from home that may be stored in refrigerators.
- Check that all equipment, including smallwares, is from approved McDonald's Kitchen Equipment Suppliers.
- Cleaning tablets for the espresso machine that are from the manufacturer of the machine, including Melitta, Urnex, and Sinfonia, are approved. Wipes and hand sanitizing wipes from Progressive Products are also approved.

**CITE**

- Food, food packaging, or equipment is not from approved sources.
- Store-bought cleaning chemicals are present.
- Unapproved hand soap is observed stocked at a hand sink (must be Ecolab-approved) **unless a McDonald's approved accommodation letter is provided**.

**COACH**

- If restaurant employee food from home is observed in any storage area, coach the manager to store all employee food in a separate refrigerator or location that is designated for employee food only.
- If a separate refrigerator or location is not an available option, coach the manager to store employee food in a refrigerator in a clearly labeled container as "Employee Food Only" and store on the bottom shelf away from all McDonald's items.



**FS29-US Employee health: Managers understand employee illness symptoms and reportable illness causes for when an employee cannot work. Managers also understand when an employee can return to work after illness.**

**ASSESSMENT**

**Employee Health**

- Inform the manager that they are not allowed to reference any materials to answer the following question:
  - Ask the manager, “Without referencing any materials, can you please recall the illness symptoms for when an employee cannot work in the restaurant?”
- The manager must recall all symptoms listed below:
  - Vomiting.
  - Diarrhea.
  - Jaundice (yellow eyes or skin).
  - Fever with Sore throat.
  - Open wound not covered.
- Observe during the visit that no employees exhibit any of the illness symptoms listed above.

**CITE**

- If the manager is not able to recall all of the symptoms listed above.
- If an employee exhibits any of the illness symptoms above during the audit.

**COACH**

- If the manager immediately references material before you can let them know of the requirement, remind the manager that they should be able to recall these from memory.

**Reportable Illnesses**

- Inform the manager that they may reference materials that are readily accessible.
- Ask the manager, “What are the reportable illnesses (or the Big 6) that require an ill employee not to report to work?”
- The manager should be able to recall the 5 main names below or refer to the readily accessible reference materials:
  - Salmonella (Nontyphoidal and Typhoid fever (caused by Salmonella Typhi)- *do not need to specify each type*).
  - Shigella.
  - Hepatitis A Virus.
  - Norovirus.
  - E.coli (shiga toxin-producing).

**CITE**

- If the manager is not able to recall all of the illnesses listed above.

**Return to Work**

- Ask the manager, “When should an ill employee be allowed to return to work?”

**CITE**

- If the employee does not state, the employee must wait for a minimum of 24 hours after becoming symptom-free, or they will contact HR Consulting for guidance. It is acceptable if the manager states any timeframe greater than 24 hours.

If the manager asks how to contact HR Consulting, share the following with them: 877-623-1955.

**FS30-US Staff training: All managers (including shift managers) trained and certified in food safety per local requirements or McDonald's minimum requirements in the absence of local regulations (apply the more stringent standard). The staff is trained on food safety per global requirements and market expectations before commencing work.**

## **ASSESSMENT**

### **Managers Trained and Certified**

- Ask how many managers work in the restaurant, then ask to see all their ServSafe or equivalent food safety certification. (Refrain from asking for manager schedules when determining how many managers are on staff.)
- Check that the certificates are Food Protection Manager certificates issued by an ANSI-approved program. Certified Food Protection Manager Certificates from the following national organizations are acceptable in addition to ServSafe:
  - Prometric (Validate the ANSI seal is visible on the Prometric certificate. Only Prometric certificates that contain the ANSI seal will be accepted).
  - Above Training State Food Safety Company.
  - National Registry of Food Safety Professionals.
  - 360 Training Company.
  - AAA Food Handler.
  - Always Food Safe Company.
- Check that the certificate dates are current.

## **CITE**

- If Certified Food Protection Manager certificates from an ANSI-accredited program are not available for each manager.
- If any manager certificate is not issued by an ANSI-accredited program.
- If the restaurant does not have the certification records for all its managers for review during the visit.

### **All Employee Training**

- Ask the manager, “Please explain your process for tracking that all employees have received food safety training.”
- Check that the manager can explain a process for tracking who has been trained on food safety.
- Check that there is a document to track employee training and that the documentation has been completed.
- The tracking document must be available for review during the audit.
- Printed and signed Station Observation Checklists (SOC's) are not required by McDonald's for tracking purposes.

## **CITE**

- If the manager cannot explain the process for tracking food safety training for all employees.
- If the completed training documentation is not available for review during the visit.

**FS31-US Food Safety Checklists: The last 60 days Daily Food Safety Checklists (DFSC) and the past two Monthly Food Safety Procedures Verifications (MFSPV) are available. There is no evidence of missing data or incorrect completions in the DFSC and MFSPV.**

## **ASSESSMENT**

### **For Digital Food Safety Records**

- Review that the Food Safety Daily Checklist completion percentage is above 90% for the past 60 days. Check the last two Monthly Food Safety Procedure Verifications are available and completed.
  - The previous two months should be reviewed as a part of this check (e.g., if the visit is in September, you will review July and August).
  - The current month should not be reviewed as a part of this check.
  - To access these reports on the approved digital food safety apps (JOLT or SQUADLE), ask the manager in charge to show you or verify using the step-by-step procedures, which can be found on the US Operations PACE website.
- If the restaurant has been on Digital Food Safety for less than 60 days or has days missing due to technical issues, you will also have to review Paper Food Safety Checklists using the “Paper Food Safety Records” assessment criteria listed below.

## **CITE**

- Less than 90% completion percentage for the last 60 days of Food Safety Daily Checklists.
- The last two Monthly Food Safety Procedure Verifications are not available and properly completed.

### **Paper Food Safety Records**

- Ask the manager to provide you with the file or booklets of completed checklists for the last 60 days.
- Check the last 14 days to verify that the Food Safety Daily Checklists are not missing the required sections or days and are being completed according to the appropriate O&T Manual procedures.
- Browse through the remaining 60 days of checklists and spot-check a few days for missing required sections or days.
- Check that the restaurant has the last two Monthly Food Safety Procedure Verifications available and completed. It is acceptable if the last two Monthly Food Safety Procedure Verifications are not completed by the 15th of the month.

## **CITE**

- If there are 3 or more missing required sections on different days, or 3 missing days within the 14-day record review.
- If the last two Monthly Food Safety Procedure Verifications are not available and properly completed.
- If 12 or more missing required sections are missing on different days or 12 missing days within the 60-day record spot check.

## **COACH**

- If minor deviations, such as a few missing products or refrigerator checks, and missing manager sign-offs are observed.
- If responses to the quality questions are not correct based on the recorded temperatures.

**FS32-US Health Department Inspections: Review the most recent health department inspection and food safety audit reports. All food safety violations noted by the health department have been corrected, or have a plan in place to correct issues.**

**ASSESSMENT**

**Health Department Inspection and Food Safety Audit Reports**

- Check that the most recent health department inspection report is available in the restaurant.
- Check that the most recent food safety audit report is available in the restaurant.
- It is acceptable for the last health department inspection and the McDonald's food safety audit report to be accessed electronically (e.g., PEAK or other websites, saved file, etc.) if not available in printed format.
- Review all violations cited in both the health department inspection and McDonald's food safety audit reports, including the comments section, which will include additional details regarding observations made during the inspection.
- Check that all critical violations cited on the health department inspection and McDonald's food safety audit reports have been corrected.
- Check that there is an action plan for any violations cited on the health department inspection and McDonald's food safety audit reports that are not yet completed.
- Food Safety audit action plans can be written on the original report, as a standalone document, or can be clearly articulated by the manager.

**CITE**

- If the most recent health department inspection report is not available.
- If any critical violations cited on the health department inspection report have not been corrected.

**COACH**

- If any non-critical violations on the health department inspection report have not been corrected.
- If food safety audit reports or McDonald's food safety audit action plan to address any violations are not available.

**FS33-US Allergen management: Market-specific allergen management program in place.**

**ASSESSMENT**

- At the McFlurry station, check to see that all nut-containing mix-ins are in orange containers with a lid and a dedicated scoop.
- Ask the manager how they deal with a customer request for allergen information.

**CITE**

- If nut-containing mix-in(s) are not in the orange container.
- If the nut-containing mix-in(s) do not have a lid on the orange container.
- If nut-free mix-in(s) is in an orange container.
- If there is no dedicated scoop for each nut containing mix-in/container.
- If the employee does not state that information on allergens can be found on the McDonald's website, the McDonald's App, or by calling the McDonald's Customer Contact Center.

**FS34 HST1 Are hands-free water taps (faucets) installed for kitchen handwashing units?**

This standard is unscored.

**Hands-Free Water Taps**

- Hands-free water faucets are installed in the kitchen at all handwashing sinks.

**Mark “No” if:**

- If water taps (faucets) are not hands-free.

**FS35 HST2 Are hands-free paper towel dispensers installed in place of hands air-dryers?**

This standard is unscored.

**Hands-Free Paper Towel Dispenser**

- Hands-free paper towel dispensers are installed in place of air-dryers in the kitchen.

**Mark “No” if:**

- If hands-free paper towel dispensers are not installed in place of air-dryers in the kitchen.

**FS36 HST3 Are hand sanitizers or a handwashing station available close to kitchen entry?**

This standard is unscored.

**Hand Sanitizer or Handwashing Stations**

- A handwashing station or hand sanitizer dispenser is visible from the entry point to the Service area behind the front counter when entering from the lobby and is located before reaching the fry station when entering the grill area.

**Mark “No” if:**

- If a handwashing station or hand sanitizer dispenser is not visible from the entry point to the Service area behind the front counter when entering from the lobby and is located before reaching the fry station when entering the grill area.